

Spoken Tutorial on Building

Module	Building
Episode	2. Understanding APIs
Learning Objective	At the end of this tutorial learner will be able to 1. Define what an API is and its fundamental purpose. 2. Explain the roles of prompts and API keys in API interactions. 3. Describe the typical flow of how applications use APIs to send requests and receive AI-generated responses.
Approx. Duration	3-4 min
Outline	• What an API is and its importance • Prompts and API keys • Application interaction with AI via APIs
Meta Tags	API, Building, AI, Prompts, API Keys, Authentication, Requests, Responses, Applications, Models, Connectors, Python
Pre-requisite Tutorial	Episode 1: Python basics for API

Script

Visual Cue	Narration
Title Slide	Welcome to this Spoken Tutorial on Building: Understanding APIs .
Learning Objectives Slide	In this tutorial, you will learn to, • Define what an API is and its fundamental purpose. • Explain the roles of prompts and API keys in API interactions. • Describe the typical flow of how applications use APIs to send requests and receive AI-generated responses.
System Requirements Slide	Here I am using a browser on a computer or mobile.
Pre-requisite Slide	To follow this tutorial, you should have knowledge of Episode 1: Python basics for API .

Illustration showing an API as a waiter connecting a customer (application) to a kitchen (another software system)	What if different software needed to talk to each other? How would they communicate? An API acts as a digital connector. Think of an API like a waiter in a restaurant. You give your order to the waiter. The waiter takes it to the kitchen, which is another system. Then, the waiter brings your meal back to you. Similarly, an API takes your request to another software. It then brings the response back to your application.
Illustration showing a user giving an instruction (prompt) and presenting a key (API key) to unlock access to a service	With that understanding, let's see how we talk to an API. We use something called a prompt. A prompt is simply an instruction or a question. You send this prompt through the API. But how does the API know who you are? This is where API keys come in. An API key is like a unique digital ID. It gives you secure access to the API service. Think of it as your secure pass.
Illustration showing a step-by-step flow: application sends request with prompt and API key, API forwards to AI model, AI processes and responds, API sends response back to application	Now, let's put it all together. How does your application use an API? First, your application sends a request. This request includes your prompt and your API key. The API receives this request. It then sends your prompt to an AI model. The AI model processes your instruction. It generates a response. Finally, the API sends this AI-generated response back to your application. This is how applications get intelligent answers.
Summary Slide	Let us summarize what we learned. We understood that an API is a digital connector between software. We also learned about prompts as instructions. API keys provide secure access to services. Finally, we saw how applications send requests. They receive AI-generated responses through APIs.
Assignment Slide	Now as an assignment, Think of any application you use daily. Consider how it might use an API. What requests could it send? What responses might it receive? Compare the results.
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